



Human Rights Commission August 18th 2025

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=zU8bjyXf7Rs
Publication Date	2025-08-18T20:58:14Z
Target Category	muncie_city

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Municipal Meeting Summary Report

1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

(Omitted: No statutory public hearings or committee sessions were held prior to calling the regular meeting to order.)

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The presiding officer called the meeting to order at [00:00:35](#) (noted as approximately 4:45 PM).
- **Attendance:**
 - **Present:** Presiding officer (Stephen), Michelle Owen (new commissioner), Linda, Leah, Andre, and Yvon (Director).
 - **Absent:** Melvin Kelly and Steve Sneed.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The presiding officer introduced new commissioner Michelle Owen, who provided brief opening remarks regarding her background as an Ivy Tech

psychology faculty member and former trauma counselor, emphasizing a passion for fostering productive communication and common ground.

- **Approval of Minutes:**
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (with abstentions noted for members not present at the prior meeting).
 - **Approval of Agenda:**
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

Note: The transcript does not contain formal ordinances, resolutions, or contracts; however, administrative reports and updates were presented and discussed chronologically.

- **00:04:12 Director's Report**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Yvon, Director.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Yvon reported on an upcoming free statewide webinar hosted by the Indiana Consortium of State and Local Human Rights Agencies scheduled for September (tentatively September 24th). The webinar features presenters from IU, a former mayor of Gary, and the ACLU director to discuss case law, voter rights/suppression, and immigration/ICE issues. Additionally, Yvon reported that the civilian review board (structured as a 501(c)(3) nonprofit) expects to appoint a new director within the next two months.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Information received and filed; no formal vote taken.
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **00:07:54** The presiding officer opened the floor for public comments. No members of the public stepped forward to speak during this period.
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6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - A board member noted an email attachment regarding an ethics commission matter, which was briefly discussed as an ongoing, unresolved item to be addressed privately by the board rather than in public session.
 - The board noted a break before beginning an upcoming mental health program session.
- **Adjournment:**

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to adjourn the public portion made by Michelle Owen, seconded by Andre. Approved by Voice Vote at [00:09:25](#).

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